

Onboarding Checklist for New Hires

Before Day One

IT provisions your laptop and accounts 3 business days before your start date. HR sends your offer packet and I-9 form for e-signature, which must be completed within 3 business days of the start date per federal requirements. New hires also receive a welcome email with parking or transit information for their assigned office, if applicable.

Week One

New hires complete Contoso 101 orientation, benefits enrollment, and meet with their manager to set 30-60-90 day goals. IT security training and the Code of Conduct acknowledgment must also be completed within the first week, and access to systems beyond the basic starter set is granted only after both are confirmed complete.

First 90 Days

Managers conduct check-ins at 30, 60, and 90 days. The first formal performance conversation happens at the 90-day mark, which also marks the end of the introductory period referenced in several other policies (e.g., 401(k) eligibility, parental leave eligibility, and full participation in the Employee Referral Program's eligibility rules).

Buddy Program

Every new hire is assigned a peer buddy from a different team for their first 60 days, to provide an informal point of contact outside the direct reporting line for questions about culture and unwritten norms. Buddies are volunteers who have been at Contoso Corp for at least 1 year, and the buddy relationship is entirely optional to continue past the 60-day period if both people find it useful.

Buddies receive a short onboarding guide of their own, covering common new-hire questions and where to redirect anything outside their own knowledge, so the buddy relationship supplements rather than replaces the manager and HR as the authoritative source for policy questions.